

Verify emergency information

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check the source, time, exact location and evidence before acting on or sharing an emergency message. Compare independent sources when possible. A forwarded screenshot, logo or urgent voice note is not verification. Act on obvious immediate danger without waiting for a post to be confirmed.

Do now.

- ☐ **Check the original**
01 Find the actual organisation or person through an independently known channel. A familiar-looking account or copied badge can be fake.
- ☐ **Check place and time**
02 Confirm the affected street, region and date. Old footage and information from another country can appear current when forwarded.
- ☐ **Compare independent information**
03 Use radio, direct trusted observations and verified humanitarian or official sources as appropriate. Several reposts of the same claim are not independent confirmation.
- ☐ **Separate facts from guesses**
04 Write what is confirmed and what remains uncertain. Do not treat a claimed ceasefire, route, water safety notice or aid offer as certain without recent verification.
- ☐ **Share carefully**
05 Forward only necessary verified information with its time and source. Protect live locations and personal information. Correct earlier messages if they prove wrong.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If connectivity fails, use the observations you can obtain safely and your written plans. Do not travel into danger to confirm a rumour or follow a single anonymous message.

Watch for.

Verification should not delay escape from visible fire, rising water or another immediate hazard. No source can guarantee that conditions remain unchanged.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Keep a short list of known sources saved offline, including non-government humanitarian sources. Choose information based on reliability and relevance, not simply whether it is official or unofficial.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Emergency alerts · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/verify-information/>